

Modifiers & Sentence Logic

Workbook 2 - Apply - Focused practice

Directions

Treat each item as editing in context. Preserve meaning while fixing grammar, mechanics, and logic.

Exercise 1

The manager said employees should submit reports only on Friday.

Task: Which meaning does the sentence most clearly express?

- A. Friday is the only day for submitting reports.
- B. Only employees, not managers, may submit reports.
- C. Employees should submit only reports and nothing else.
- D. The manager speaks only on Friday.

Exercise 2

Using the updated map, the detour was easier for drivers to follow.

Task: Choose the best revision.

- A. Using the updated map, drivers could follow the detour more easily.
- B. Using the updated map, the detour was easier for drivers to follow.
- C. The map used the drivers to follow the detour.
- D. Using the detour, the map followed the drivers.

Exercise 3

The lab nearly recorded every temperature reading.

Task: Choose the revision meaning all readings were recorded and their values were close to each other.

- A. The lab recorded nearly every temperature reading.
- B. The lab recorded every temperature reading, and the values were nearly the same.
- C. Nearly the lab recorded every temperature reading.
- D. The lab nearly recorded every temperature reading.

Exercise 4

Before approving the schedule, the staffing levels were reviewed.

Task: Choose the clearest revision.

- A. Before approving the schedule, the director reviewed the staffing levels.
- B. Before approving the schedule, the staffing levels were reviewed.
- C. The staffing levels approved the schedule after review.
- D. Before approval, reviewing staffing levels was scheduled.

Answer reasoning

Check the rule and the meaning, not only the letter.

For every miss, identify whether the problem was grammar, punctuation, word meaning, sentence logic, or a rushed reading of the context.

Exercise 1

Best answer: A. Friday is the only day for submitting reports.

Why: Only sits directly before the time phrase on Friday.

Exercise 2

Best answer: A. Using the updated map, drivers could follow the detour more easily.

Why: Drivers are the users of the map, so they must follow the opening phrase.

Exercise 3

Best answer: B. The lab recorded every temperature reading, and the values were nearly the same.

Why: The original nearly modifies recorded and suggests the recording almost happened. The revision states the intended two ideas explicitly.

Exercise 4

Best answer: A. Before approving the schedule, the director reviewed the staffing levels.

Why: The director is now clearly the person who approves and reviews.

Mistake check

Rewrite one missed sentence correctly. Then state the rule in one short sentence you could use on a new example.